When the agent queries the policy system using typed partial evaluation—with the principal and target resource known but other parts of the request left unspecified—Cedar produces a policy residual. A simplified residual might look like:

```
@id("policy-7-deny-credential-files")
forbid(principal, action, resource);
```

This residual expresses that, under the current conditions, all relevant actions are forbidden. The agent's language model processes this result and infers that accessing the credentials directory will not succeed. Note that the residual includes the `@id` attributes, allowing the agent to identify relevant policies.

Instead of attempting the action and receiving a denial, the agent responds:

> *I don't have permission to access that directory.*

It then adjusts its plan without invoking the tool. This interaction illustrates how residuals are used in practice.

- Cedar does not return a list of allowed actions.
- It returns a logical expression describing what is permitted or forbidden.
- The agent interprets that expression and incorporates it into its reasoning.

This makes the policy system a source of guidance, not just enforcement.

C.4.4 Compare with reactive behavior

To see the difference clearly, compare this prompt in demo 1 and demo 2. In demo 1 (reactive):

- agent attempts to read the directory
- policy denies the request
- agent replans